

around the house for a few days while his attorney was working out an ironclad plan to get the IRS paid back. Then he came to his wife and said, "I'll do it. It's stupid, but I gave my word and I'll do it."

It was several weeks before I saw them again and heard what happened. "The first week I set out to get some jobs mowing lawns, I realized I was in trouble," he said. "I found myself in competition with 12-year-old kids, so I told my neighbors I needed exercise but also needed the money as an incentive. I figured they didn't buy it when we would find care packages on our doorstep. But I stuck it out even though I was down to two bucks a lawn sometimes. Finally, I paid that bill off, and I felt like I had been released from prison. Then I realized what an impact it had made on me. One day I was driving around and saw a Greyhound bus that had been converted to a motor home. Man, I have always wanted one of those motor homes. But you know what stopped me? Just thinking about mowing lawns to pay off a \$66,000 motor home," he explained.

If you happen to be among that fortunate 10 percent who make a significant income—and some of you will be, at some point—remember it's NOT what you make that generates debt. It's what you spend.

THE AVERAGE SPENDER

The remaining 80 percent of our population are not basically frugal enough to stay out of debt, nor do they make enough money to buy their way out of trouble. These families represent the norm. Although everybody SHOULD live on a budget, this group MUST live on a budget or risk getting deeply into debt. Easy credit is one of the most subtle traps Satan lays for Christian families. God's Word says watch out: "The prudent sees the evil and hides himself, but the naive go on, and are punished for it" (Proverbs 22:3).

Again, let me make the point here that borrowing itself is NOT a problem. If used prudently, some credit is reasonable. Even when somebody borrows so much that he or she can't